

There is some confusion as to what it will be called; we think Zoho Mail, though in some parts of the site it's also referred to as Zoho Virtual Office. Given the functionality, Virtual Office may be more apt, but for now we'll stick with "Zoho Mail."

According to the site, it is going to be available "free for individuals" and at \$3 (Rs 125) per user per month. Each user—free or paid—will get 1 GB of free storage, which can be used to store e-mail as well as documents. Paid users get additional space for storage of group documents.

When you log in to Zoho Mail, you are presented with the Desktop—a dashboard-like view of your mail, tasks, events, notes, shared documents, groups, announcements, reminders, and buddy list. This is a single-glance snapshot of your workday, which looks and feels somewhat more integrated than Zoho Planner. On the left pane, you can click on various icons that will open different applications like e-mail, calendar, tasks, and so on.

E-mail can be configured to pull your messages from one or more POP accounts. This includes support for secure SSL accounts, which is a plus especially for business users who may need to set up secure connections for their e-mail. The e-mail icon opens a typical Web-based e-mail interface. You work with it as you would with any e-mail application. In addition to the regular features you can also create tasks, events, notes and extract links from individual messages. This kind of cross integration feature provides great leaps in productivity when you want to quickly do things like create an appointment or add a task or annotate some notes based on a specific mail message.

You use the calendar to schedule your appointments and events. You can also create tasks based on the event or appointment, which is useful, though you do end up wishing that you could also see your tasks and other time-sensitive activities right within the calendar to give you an idea of current and future workloads.